

How to Keep Your Smile Moving In the Right Direction

Your Key To Success

- Your aligners should be worn 20-22 hours per day – except when eating, brushing, and flossing.
- Remove your aligners before eating or drinking anything other than water.
- Brush and floss after meals and beverages, especially after drinking any sugary or acidic beverages. Anything that is left on your teeth could be trapped under your aligners.
 - ◊ If you do not have a toothbrush available, rinse with water and chew a piece of sugar-free gum that contains Xylitol for 10 minutes before putting your aligners back in.
- Do not chew gum with aligners in. You may suck on sugar-free mints.
- Wear your aligners for 1-week cycles, unless otherwise recommended by your doctor or the clinical staff.
 - ◊ If you still feel pressure from your aligners after 1 week of wear, you may wear your current aligners up to a week longer before changing to the next aligner.
- Bite on chewies for the first 1-2 days with each new aligner. Bite, hold, and squeeze in the areas recommended by your doctor for 10-15 seconds in each spot, for a total of 2 minutes. This will help keep aligners fitting well and prevent air gaps.
 - ◊ If you are using your chewie and still experiencing an air gap, please contact our office to come in for our clinical staff to evaluate the fit of your aligner.
- Do not go long periods of time without wearing aligners.
 - ◊ If a new aligner does not fit, wear the best-fitting aligner until you are seen at our office.
 - ◊ Bring any aligners that have not been worn with you to your appointments.
 - ◊ We do not require that you keep all of your aligners, however, we recommend that you keep your previous aligner in case of an emergency.
- If any bonded attachments or buttons come off, please contact our office for further assistance.

How to Keep Your Aligners Clean and Safe

- Gently clean your aligners with a toothbrush and toothpaste 1-2 times daily. You may use the recommended Retainer Brite® cleaner tablets, available for purchase at the front desk.
- Store aligners in your aligner case when they are not being worn as this will help prevent the risk of accidentally discarding them. Do not wrap your aligners in paper towel or set them freely on plates or counters. Store future inventory of aligners in a cool, dry place.
- Keep your aligners away from pets, boiling water, bleach, and any other cleaning products.
- You may use EverSmile® WhiteFoam daily to help keep your aligners fresh, whiten teeth, and help with dry mouth. This is available for purchase at the front desk. (Do not use other whitening products as they will damage the attachments on your teeth.)
- Do not soak your aligners in mouthwash.

Note: Please continue to see your general dentist every 6 months for regular cleanings and check-ups. If restorative work is ever needed, please contact our office for further assistance.